



AOC enters Indian TV market

AOC has entered India's TV market. The Taiwanese brand is part of TPV Technology, globally known for its LED/LCD TVs. <http://dgit.in/GMk66K>

Intex sound bar speakers

Intex has unveiled its first wireless sound bar home theatre systems in India, starting ₹9,999. <http://dgit.in/GMk9iE>

Blu-ray Player Test

Sony PlayStation 3 Slim

While this is essentially a gaming console, the Blu-ray drive adds a whole lot of value to it, particularly if you don't have a separate Blu-ray player. As that, it's a very competent device, and doesn't lack anything in terms of features and performance. However, it does lack native support for many codecs, but if you're streaming from a network-connected PC using the PS3 Media Server, then it will flawlessly play

back all formats. Picture quality of media viewed through the PS3 is quite excellent. What you will notice is that the PS3 does tend to heat up considerably more, thanks to the immense power locked within the confines of its plastic enclosure. The gaming remote is quite uncomfortable to use for media playback, and you'll have to spend on Sony's PS3 Blu-ray remote to enjoy media playback.



Sony Playstation 3 Slim



Sony Playstation 3 Blu-ray remote

has the slowest boot time of all players in the test. The Blu-ray playback is excellent, and the image is definitely crisper than its lower-priced sibling. Any video that you play, unless it's originally in 3D, will start in the standard 2D mode. The remote has a 3D button, which will give you a pop-up of types of 3D to upscale to - Full HD 3D or side-by-side 3D. Select the one that you want; we used Full HD 3D. The display then blanks out for anywhere between 5 and 15 seconds and voila, it's 3D. Incidentally, the video doesn't automatically pause during this process. 3D quality is quite good, but then again, things like depth and colour reproduction are dependent on the individual 3D TV. Upscale quality of SD files to HD is quite good, be it off a DVD or a USB drive. Speaking of which, the BD110 had some issues reading one of the three USB drives we used in this test. It failed to read a 16GB pen drive in Fat32 format with some MP4 and AVI files on it. It read the other two promptly (albeit both were in NTFS format), which made us wonder what the real issue was here. It couldn't be the USB drive, since all other players

including the Panasonic BD75 read it perfectly. We groaned at the sight of the user interface, which follows a similar selection via direction key, which is bound to confuse new users. However, it looks a lot more colourful and better laid out, with multiple screens as you go deep into the options. This product has integrated Wi-Fi and with that a whole host of web-based services such as YouTube, Big Flix VOD service, Twitter and Skype. You'll need to have a compatible web camera for video calling to work. Within the apps interface, we liked the window look. However, windows beyond page 3, where some services aren't available in India, are blank.

The Winners

For a combination of very good performance, wide compatibility with video formats and external devices, decent feature set and simple enough looks, the Philips BDP3200 wins the **Best Performer Award**. Alternatively, the Philips BDP5200, offers everything the BDP3200 has, and bundles along integrated Wi-Fi, a sleek yet simple interface and a whole host of web-based services to justify the price tag. The Sony BDP S380

wins the **Best Value Award**. While it lacks DivX playback capability, it makes up for that with the amazingly functional PS3-esque user interface and nifty features like x.v.Colour, something that the Philips

misses out on. The LG BD670 gets our **Editor's Pick Award**. It offers quick startup times, an intuitive UI, a full-fledged app store with a firmware update and impressive Blu-ray playback and SD video upscaling.

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